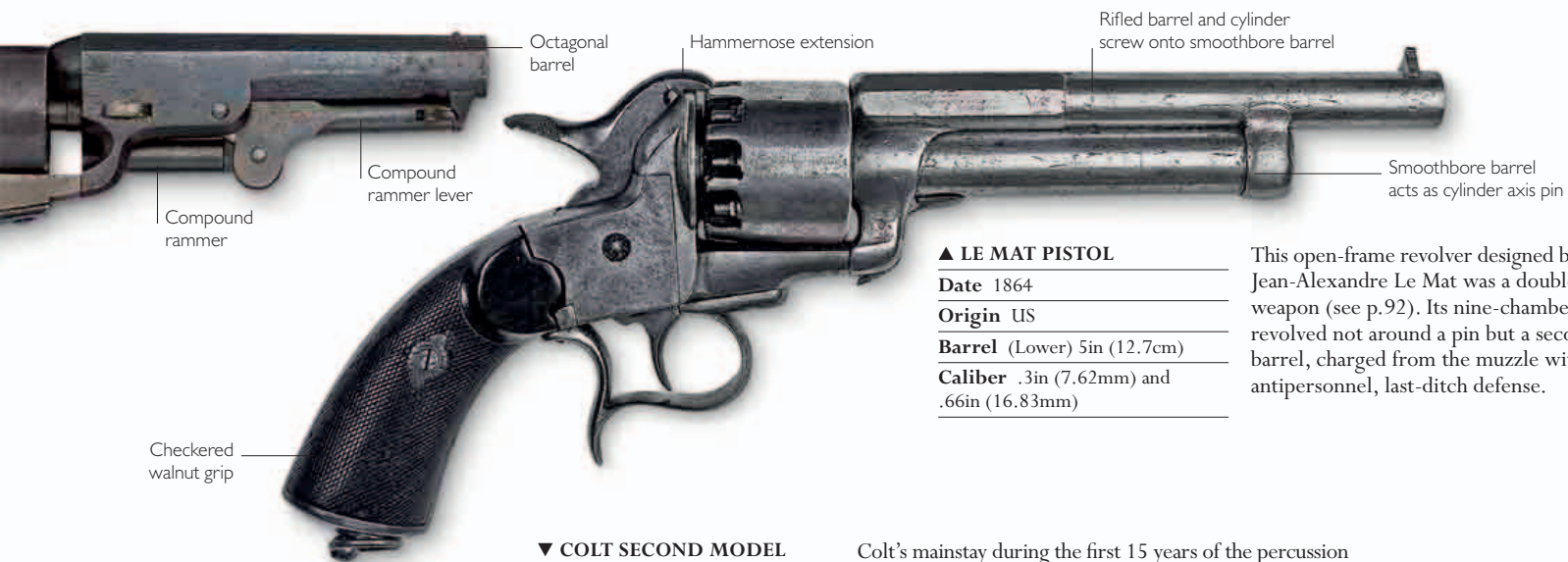




▲ LE MAT PISTOL

Date 1864

Origin US

Barrel (Lower) 5in (12.7cm)

Caliber .3in (7.62mm) and .66in (16.83mm)

This open-frame revolver designed by Frenchman Jean-Alexandre Le Mat was a double-action weapon (see p.92). Its nine-chambered cylinder revolved not around a pin but a second, unrifled barrel, charged from the muzzle with pellets, for antipersonnel, last-ditch defense.

▼ COLT SECOND MODEL DRAGOON PISTOL

Date 1849

Origin US

Barrel 7½in (19cm)

Caliber .44in (11.17mm)

Colt's mainstay during the first 15 years of the percussion era was the Dragoon Pistol, so called because it was intended as a sidearm for cavalymen. A new factory was built at Hartford in Connecticut to produce this single-action revolver to fulfill an army contract.



► STARR ARMY MODEL

Date 1864

Origin US

Barrel 7½in (19.2cm)

Caliber .44in (11.17mm)

American gunmaker Nathan Starr was the pioneer of the break-open pistol, in which the barrel, top strap, and cylinder were hinged at the front of the frame before the trigger guard. The cylinder could be removed for cleaning or for replacing with another. The forked top strap of this solid-frame, double-action revolver passed over the hammer and was retained by a knurled screw.